



Procurement Operations Division

DHA HEALTH.MIL TRICARE DHHQ

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FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY - Source Selection Information – See FAR 2.101 and 3.104

Request for Bridge Action Approval

J&A Tracking Number: JA-25-0397B

CAE #:

Contract Information - Bridge Action

Contractor Name: [REDACTED]
Procurement Instrument Identifier (PIID): HT003823C0003
Period of Performance: From 3/27/2025 to 8/26/2026
Contract Type: FAR 16.306 Cost-Plus-Fixed-Fee
Contracting Officer: [REDACTED]
Contracting Office: Defense Healthcare Management Systems Contracting Division
Program Manager/Project Officer/COR: [REDACTED]
Program Office (JDIR): [REDACTED]

Contract Information - Predecessor Contract(s)

J&A Tracking No. (if applicable)	PIID Number	Contractor Name	Duration (Months)
JA-23-007B	HT003823C0003	American Systems Corporation	24

Bridge Action Background

Reason for Bridge Action: Source Selection Delays

RFI Completed: Yes

Waiver Needed: No

Bridge Action Duration (months, to include FAR 52.217-8, Option to Extend Services) 17 months

Anticipated Award Date for Follow-on Contract (i.e., Competitive Follow-on Acquisition, not the Bridge Action) 12/26/2025

Previous Bridge Action? Yes

Number of Prior Bridge Actions: 1

FUNDS

Total Amount of Funds - Previous Bridge Action (if applicable): [REDACTED]

Total Amount of Funds - This Bridge Action Request: [REDACTED]

Total Amount Spent - This Scope of Work: [REDACTED]

Total Cost Variance (+/-): [REDACTED]

Funding Type: Operations & Maintenance (O&M)

Funding Fiscal Year: 25

PROGRAM RISK IMPACT

Risk Scale of Importance: Critical

Impact if Not Executed:

If the bridge contract is not awarded, the resulting service interruptions would have severe operational, financial, and reputational consequences. Such disruptions would compromise the health and well-being of servicemembers, veterans, and their families by delaying or degrading access to critical healthcare services. Additionally, PEO DHMS' ability to fulfill its mandate of providing reliable, efficient healthcare systems would be significantly undermined, exposing the organization to heightened scrutiny and potential Congressional inquiries regarding program delays or failures.

This bridge contract is not merely a matter of convenience but an operational and strategic necessity to ensure uninterrupted delivery of mission-critical services. Its careful calibration reflects the agency's commitment to mitigating risks, safeguarding ongoing operations, and sustaining progress toward the implementation of a modernized ESS architecture. Without this contract, PEO DHMS would face cascading impacts that could jeopardize its mission readiness and operational effectiveness, potentially resulting in significant harm to stakeholders and a loss of confidence in its ability to manage critical healthcare programs.

Impact if Executed to a Lesser Amount (Scalability):

Scaling down the aforementioned services is not feasible at this time, as they are essential to PEO DHMS' ability to fulfill its mission obligations. Until the transition to ESS Next is successfully completed, these critical services must continue to be provided in order to ensure continuity and support the organization's ongoing operations. As such, PEO DHMS recognizes the importance of maintaining these services while the follow-on contract is being developed and solicited, and cannot reduce or eliminate them without compromising its ability to achieve its mission objectives.

Mitigation Strategy for Preventing Further Bridge Actions:

We are currently in the process of developing the follow-on action, ESS Next. With the ESS Next RFI and Industry Day scheduled for January 2025, followed by the release of the solicitation in May 2025, and an anticipated award in October 2025, we will be transitioning to a competitive acquisition process. As ESS Next will be a commercially competitive procurement, it will fulfill the requirements that previously required a J&A and a bridge action. Therefore, the need for a J&A and bridge action will be obviated, as the competitive procurement process will satisfy the necessary requirements.

REVIEWING OFFICIALS/APPROVAL AUTHORITY

Program Manager or Functional Service Manager

Approved: [REDACTED]

including delays to critical testing and development activities, underscore the need for this interim solution. Without it, the ability to maintain program schedules and meet mission objective would be significantly compromised. This bridge action demonstrates a pragmatic approach to preserving operational continuity while maintaining progress toward a competitively awarded follow-on contract. I approve this request and support its timely execution as a necessary step in sustaining PEO DHMS's mission readiness.

Program Director

Approved:

Comments:

Contracting Officer

Approved:

Comments:

Chief, Contracting Office

Approved:

Comments:

Head of the Contracting Activity

Approved:

Comments:

Senior Procurement Executive

Approved:

Comments:

Attachments

ESS Bridge J&A Concurrence_Approvals 2.19.2025.pdf

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